

GLOSSARY

ASTRINGENT A sensation of the texture of tea's **liquor**, which causes tissues in the mouth to contract.

Ayurveda A system of traditional Hindu medicine using plant-based treatments.

AUTUMNAL Describes leaves picked late in the harvest (September–October), noted for their mellow flavors.

BODY The overall depth of flavor often associated with black tea.

BRICK TEA A compressed tea cake, made by pressing steamed tea leaves into the shape of a brick.

BRIGHT A description of flavor in black tea, usually characterized by a mild astringency and fresh flavor.

BRISK A tasting term to describe a lively, slightly astringent sensation. Usually associated with black tea, especially Ceylon.

CAFFEINE A naturally occurring chemical stimulant. It is produced in young leaf buds to protect them from insects.

CAMELLIA SINENSIS An evergreen shrub whose leaves and leaf buds are used to produce tea. There are two varieties: var. *sinensis* and var. *assamica*.

CATECHINS A type of polyphenol and powerful antioxidant found in tea that helps to stabilize free radicals (cells that are damaged by environmental pollution).

CHANOYU An elaborate and formal Japanese tea ceremony, which dictates certain movements, procedures, and equipment to be used for the making and serving of Matcha tea.

CHASEN A small whisk constructed of a single piece of bamboo that has been sliced into fine tines, and is used to whisk Matcha with water.

CHAWAN A sturdy ceramic-footed bowl used to prepare Matcha. It is used in the Japanese **Chanoyu** ceremony.

CULTIVARS A cultivated variety of plant intentionally bred with particular flavor or growing attributes.

DECOCTION A preparation made by boiling herbs in water.

FLUSH The growth of new buds on the tea bush that occurs several times during the plucking/harvesting season.

GAIWAN A Chinese lidded bowl with saucer, usually made of porcelain or glass. It is used to make small quantities of tea for tasting.

GRADE A method used in Sri Lanka, Kenya, and India to determine the quality of the dry leaf based on appearance alone.

INFUSION The liquid tea made by soaking tea leaves in hot (or sometimes cold) water.

KILL GREEN The process of steaming or **pan-firing** tea leaves that will be used for green tea. This prevents the leaves from oxidizing.

L THEANINE A unique amino acid found in tea, which can reduce stress and induce a sense of well-being.

LIQUOR The strained tea liquid created from infusing tea leaves in hot water.

MOUTHFEEL A description of the physical sensation of drinking tea, such as soft, astringent, or creamy.

NOSE The aroma of the **liquor**.

ORTHODOX A method of production of tea that aims to keep the tea leaf as whole as possible.

OXIDATION The process of the (partial or complete) chemical breakdown of enzymes in tea leaves upon exposure to oxygen and heat.

PAN-FIRED Refers to green tea leaves that have been stirred in a wok pan to dry them or “kill green.”

PEKOE (pronounced peck-o) The fine hairs on new tea buds. Also a term used in the British grading system indicating a fine grade of tea.

POLYPHENOLS Antioxidants that help detox the body. Tea has around eight times more polyphenols than fruits or vegetables.

PU'ER A dark tea from China's Yunnan province with probiotic content that develops as the tea ages. Is available in loose leaf or cake form.

TISANE A herbal infusion made from the leaves, roots, seeds, fruit, flowers, or bark of plants.

TERROIR The particular conditions in which tea is grown.

UMAMI A Japanese term for savory flavor, which is found in many steamed Japanese green teas.

VOLATILE OILS The aromatic oils in tea leaves that will evaporate on exposure to heat and oxygen.

YIXING A region in Jiangsu province, China, where a dark purple clay is used to create unglazed tea pots using a hand building technique. These are called Yixing pots.